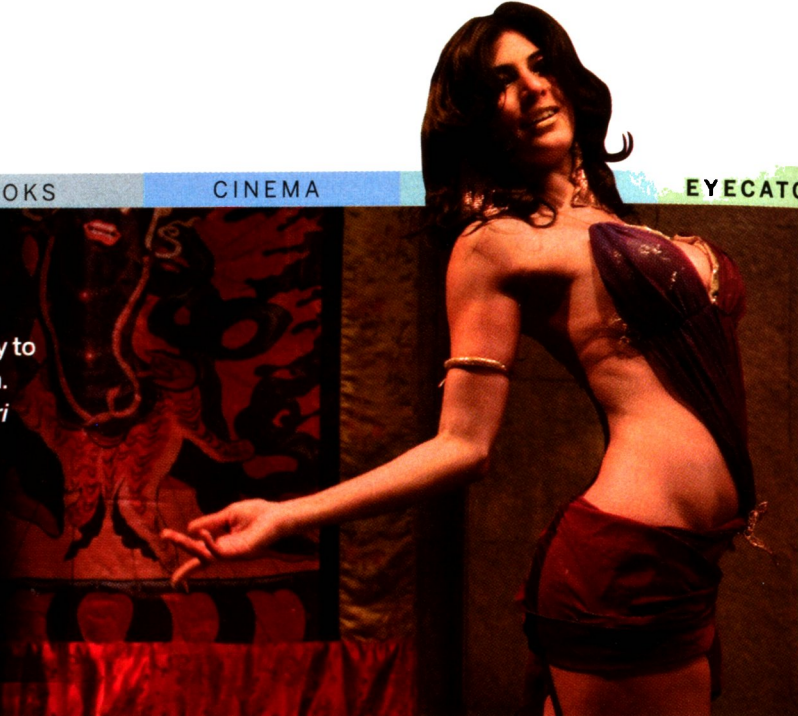


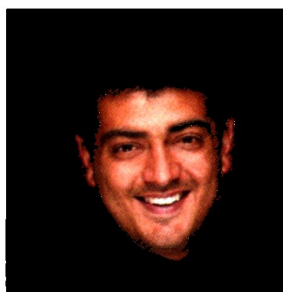
ITEM BOMB

Maria Gomes, 25, the newest Brazilian beauty to hit Bollywood, has been scorching the screen. Her sizzling performance in item number *Teri neeyat kharab hai* in *Teen Patti* opposite Amitabh Bachchan has left heads turned. "The song needed a powerful performer and Gomes had the talent and confidence for it," says director Leena Yadav. She is being compared to Salma Hayek, and Yadav has been flooded with inquiries from filmmakers. This Brazilian certainly has B-town besotted.



Playing with Fire

Actor Ajith Kumar, 37, is taking on the DMK. At a recent event to felicitate CM M. Karunanidhi, he spoke out against the party pressuring actors to appear at political functions. A political furore resulted, but Kumar is being supported by none other than superstar Rajnikanth. Considering most production houses are owned by the political family, Kumar may have bitten off more than he can chew.



Screen Switch

Television's favourite bahu Smriti Irani, 33, is finally making the big move. She is debuting opposite Victor Bannerjee in a Bengali film titled *Amrita*. Director Tapan Saha cast her in the film after learning that Irani speaks Bengali. We hope this film takes off, unlike her political career and previous film projects.



British Indian R&B singer Amar is crooning with Bollywood. The Punjabi lass has been jamming with Sonu Nigam, Shankar-Ehsan-Loy and Apache Indian for her new album *Show it Off*. And music may just be in her genes. After all, her father Mangal Singh sang yesteryear anthems like *Rail gaddi* and *Kali teri choti*.

**SPICE UP
LIFE'S BORING
MOMENTS.**

